MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers Absorbable Gelatin sponges.

1.2 Classification. The sponges covered by this specification shall be the following types (See 6.2):

Type I - 20 by 20 by 7 mm, 15s
Type II - 20 by 60 by 7 mm, 12s
Type III - 80 by 125 by 10 mm, 6s

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

PPP-B-566	Box, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Box, Setup.
PPP-C-186	Containers, Packaging and Packing for Drugs, Chemicals, and Pharmaceuticals. (See 6.4)

Military

MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.
MIL-S-36586	Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

FSC 6510

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STANDARD

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

AMERICAN PHARMACEUTICAL ASSOCIATION PUBLICATION

National Formulary.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION, AND WELFARE, FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Food and Drug Administration, Washington, DC 20204.)

U.S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopeia of the United States.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The absorbable gelatin sponge shall be a light, nearly white, pliable, nonantigenic, nonelastic, tough, porous matrix showing no tendency to disintegrate, even with relatively rough handling, and shall be in accordance with the tests, standards, and requirements of the U.S.P., including any supplements or revisions thereto. The first three lines of this paragraph up to

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3.1 Material (cont'd)

the word "handling" may be regarded as descriptive, however the material shall be tested as specified in the specification. It shall be suitable for use as a local hemostatic in oral and dental surgery and shall be capable of absorbing and holding, within its meshes, many times its weight of whole blood for type I.

3.1.1 Absorbability. When implanted in tissues, the absorbable gelatin sponge shall be completely absorbed in from four to six weeks without including excessive scar tissue formation. Absorbability testing shall be performed on one (1) lot for one (1) contract provided the contractor certifies that the manufacturing procedure for each subsequent lot and contract is identical to the procedure used to manufacture the one lot subject to the absorbability test. On subsequent contracts the supplier shall submit certification that the lots offered to the Government were manufactured identically as the material subjected to the absorbability test. At the supplier's option the same or different lot numbers of ingredients may be used.

3.1.2 Heat durability. The sponge shall withstand a dry heat at 150°C. for 4 hours without showing decomposition. The darkening in color from yellow to slightly brown of the Absorbable Gelatin Sponge is not considered decomposition of the material.

3.1.3 Dimensions. Each Absorbable Gelatin Sponge shall comply with the measurements specified below for the appropriate Type:

Type I	Type II	Type III
Width 18 to 22 mm	Width 18 to 22 mm	Width 70 to 99 mm
Height 18 to 22 mm	Height 52.5 to 67.5mm	Height 110 to 150 mm
Thickness 5.3 to 9.8 mm	Thickness 5.3 to 9.8 mm	Thickness 8 to 12.5 mm

At least ten (10) sponges shall be examined to determine whether the sponges comply with the above dimensions and not more than one (1) sponge shall deviate from the above by more than ± 15% in width, ± 25% in height, and ± 30% in thickness.

3.2 Sterility. The absorbable gelatin sponges shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.4.

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3.2.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of quality shall include:

a. Item identification.
b. National Stock No.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number. (Upon approval of the procuring activity, the pharmaceutical lot number will be acceptable.)
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101 and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant quality assurance representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.3 Potency period. The potency period (Expiration Dating Period) shall be 60 months for type I. The potency period shall be 36 months for type II and III.

3.4 Delivery.

3.4.1 For type I. Not less than 56 months of the expiration dating period (potency period) shall remain at time of delivery to the Government.

3.4.2 For type II and III. Not less than 33 months of the expiration dating period (potency period) shall remain at time of delivery to the Government.

3.5 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The sponge and its components shall be free from defects.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Supplier responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 5 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 No company supplying any ingredient(s) to the contractor will be considered an acceptable facility for the performance of any inspection requirements specified herein.

4.2 Lot. For purposes of this specification, a lot, batch, or control is that single, uniform, and homogeneous quantity of absorbable gelatin sponge produced from one formulation, subjected to the same compounding and manufacturing operations, and placed into the final containers.

4.2.1 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in the labeling requirements. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

4.2.2 Upon approval of the procuring activity, the assigning of pharmaceutical lot (quality control) numbers without showing individual load (charge) designation (sterility lot) will be acceptable, provided samples from each sterilizer charge are tested and reserve samples representing each sterilizer charge are retained for future testing, as needed. The inoculated carrier need not be accompanied by the reserve samples.

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4.3 Sampling. Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with the procedures set forth in MIL-STD-105, with an inspection level of S-2 and an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 1.0 percent defective for major defects.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination will be conducted in accordance with the following classification of defects:

Categories	Defects*
Major	
101	Absorbable gelatin sponge does not comply with the specified measurements.
102	Sponge not free from foreign matter.

* Inspection is not restricted to the classified possible defects listed above.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Sterility test. The absorbable gelatin sponges shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the U.S.P. for "Solids". using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time, in each case, shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in 4.4.1.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units.

4.4.1.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C.
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C.
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C.
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C.
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C.

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

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4.4.1.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips), if used, shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586 except in paragraph 3.2.4 of MIL-S-36586, delete the first sentence in its entirety and substitute the following sentence: "The test sets shall have a potency period of not less than 18 months." The required information specified in paragraph 3.2.2 of MIL-S-36586 for the test strips and the control strips need not necessarily appear in black and red ink respectively. Additionally, the same kind of spore strips used for the test strips may also be used for the controls. If the spore strips are not packaged in the procedure envelopes as specified in 3.2.3 of MIL-S-36586, the required information shall be furnished.

4.5 Examination for preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of Section. Defects shall be scored as specified in Table I. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table I. Examination for Preparation for Delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preparation for delivery shall be in accordance with all applicable requirements of PPP-C-186 and as specified herein.

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5.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Unit of issue. One box containing twelve individually packaged type 2 sponges or six individually packaged type 3 sponges, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue. One jar containing fifteen type 1 sponges, as specified, constitutes a unit of issue.

5.2.2 Level A.

5.2.2.1 Immediate container.

5.2.2.1.1 Type 1. Fifteen type I sponges shall be packaged in a jar conforming to Group A, class 1, Type e, Style 4, Grade 2 and having a Closure A, B or F and Seal A or B as specified in PPP-C-186. Paragraph 3.2.4 Capacity of fill, of PPP-C-186 shall not apply.

5.2.2.1.2 Type 2 and Type 3. Each sponge shall be packaged in a white paper envelope (inner envelope) and then enclosed in a outer peel-open, nonresealable type envelope. The flap of the inner envelope shall not be sealed. The inner envelope containing the sponge shall be sealed within an outer peel-open, nonresealable, paper envelope. The paper used in the outer peel-open envelope shall be capable of withstanding dry heat sterilization at 300°F. for 4 hours and still maintain sufficient strength to be opened. The adhesive used for the outer peel-open envelope shall also be capable of withstanding dry heat sterilization at 300°F. for 4 hours and still remain capable of being peeled open.

5.2.2.2 Unit pacakge. One jar containing fifteen type 1 sponges or twelve individually packaged type 2 sponges or six individually packaged type 3 sponges shall be packaged in a snugg fitting box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure of the box shall be secured.

5.2.2.3 Intermediate package. Six unit packages containing type 1 sponges shall be packaged in a snug fitting box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic or PPP-B-676. Closure of the box shall be secured. Intermediate package shall not be required for type 2 and type 3 sponges.

5.2.3 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

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5.3 Packing.

5.3.1 Level A. Twenty-four intermediate packages (144 units) containing type 1 sponges or sixteen unit packages containing type 2 sponges or twelve unit packages containing type 3 sponges shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant except that grade W5c shall not be acceptable as an exterior container. Exterior containers containing type 1 sponges shall include liners, top and bottom pads. When intermediate containers are stacked in two or more tiers, a pad shall be interposed between each tier. Liners and pads shall be fabricated of double-faced corrugated fiberboard having a minimum bursting strength of 200 pounds in accordance with PPP-B-636, class domestic. Liners and pads shall not be required when intermediate packages conform to PPP-B-636. Closure, waterproofing and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.3.2 Level B. Sponges shall be packed as specified in 5.3.1 except that the exterior container shall conform to PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Waterproofing and strapping shall not be required and the closure shall conform to method II as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.3.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Labeling. Labeling shall be in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and shall include the following information for the type specified.

5.4.1.1 Immediate container (commercial labeling). Each immediate container label for type 1 and the labels of the outer peel-open envelopes for type II and type III shall bear the following information:

(a) label information in accordance with commercial practice.

(b) the expiration date.

NOTE: The inner envelope for type II and III shall not be labeled.

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5.4.1.2 Immediate container (military labeling). Should the supplier not furnish labels in accordance with commercial practice, the labels of the immediate container for type 1 and the labels of the outer peel-open outer nonresealable envelopes for type II and type III shall bear the following information:

(a) the National Stock Number

(b) the item name designated as

"SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP, 20 by 20 by 7 mm, 15s" for Type I

"SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP, 20 by 60 by 7 mm, 12s" for Type II

"SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP 80 by 125 by 10 mm, 6s" for Type III

(c) the name and address of the manufacturer. When the manufacturer is not the contractor, the name and address of the contractor shall also appear.

When both names are placed on the label, the following designations shall precede the names:

"MFR" for the manufacturer.
"CONTR" for the contractor.

(d) sterility lot (control) number.
(e) a statement that sterility is void if package is broken.
(f) expiration date.

5.4.1.3 Unit package (commercial labeling). Each unit package label for type I, type II and type III shall bear the following information:

(a) labeling information in accordance with commercial practice.
(b) the National Stock Number.
(c) the expiration date.
(d) the level and date of packaging.
(e) the method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, C-Cold, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat) shall be shown following the level of packaging and date of packaging. Example: A-1/75-G

NOTE: The National Stock Number shall not be preceded by any prefix.

Strip labeling may be used.

Labeling adhesion test shall not apply.

Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

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5.4.1.4 Unit package (military labeling). Should the supplier not furnish labels in accordance with commercial practice, the labels of the unit package for type I, type II and type III should bear the following information.

(a) the National Stock Number.
(b) the item name designated as

"SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP, 20 by 20 by 7 mm, 15s" for type I

"SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP, 20 by 60 by 7 mm, 12s" for type II

"SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP, 80 by 125 by 10 mm, 6s" for type III

(c) the name and address of the manufacturer. When the manufacturer is not the contractor, the name and address of the contractor shall appear.

When both names are placed on the label, the following designations shall precede the names:

"MFG" for the manufacturer.
"CONTR" for the contractor.

(d) sterility lot (control) number.
(e) the expiration date.
(f) the level and date of packaging.
(g) the method of sterilization as specified in 5.4.1.3.

5.4.1 Intermediate package. Each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Lot (control) number, contract or purchase order number, and name of contractor shall be shown. Type I Shelf Life marking as specified in MIL-STD-129 shall be shown. Marking shall include the method of sterilization as specified in 5.4.1.3.

5.4.3 Exterior container. Exterior containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-129. Lot (control) number shall be shown. Type I Shelf Life Marking as specified in MIL-STD-129 shall be shown. Marking shall include the method of sterilization as specified in 5.4.1.3.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) the National Stock No.
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.2 and 5.3).

6.2 This specification covers the following item:

National Stock No.	Item Identification
6510-00-064-4858	SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP, 20 by 20 by 7 mm, 15s
6510-00-080-2053	SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP, 20 by 60 by 7 mm, 12s
6510-00-080-2054	SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP, 80 by 125 by 10 mm, 6s

6.3 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet Military requirements.

6.4 All references to PPP-C-186 refer to Interim Federal Specification PPP-C-00186B which is mandatory for use until superceded by a revision.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6510-0596
cs

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-S-37092 SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS	CONTRACT NUMBER
	MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A ☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*	TELEPHONE NO.
	DATE

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